

Does Mulryne succeed in his efforts to restore *Tormato's* place in the Yes pantheon? I'm still not convinced, but I'm impressed with his efforts. It is easy to see in hindsight how the band's quest for "new sounds" led to new directions after the obligations of the *Tormato* tours. Anderson and Wakeman both departed, and Trevor Horn and Geoff Downes (from the new wave band Buggles) replaced them for the hastily recorded and musically controversial *Drama* (1980). Anderson soon returned, and Horn stepped back to produce Yes for their commercial smash *90215*, with its hit "Owner of a Lonely Heart." *Tormato* was, in retrospect, the closing of one chapter in Yes's history, with tantalizing glimpses of the chapter to come. *Reviewed by Kevin Holm-Hudson*

***Roots Punk: A Visual and Oral History.* By David A. Ensminger. Jackson: University Press of Mississippi, 2023. 206pp (paperback). ISBN 978-1-4968-4842-0.**

In public consciousness punk is embedded historically within a broader historical narrative of musical commercialization—that is, punk is framed as a response to commercialized rock and roll styles. When punk is co-opted by popular music culture, musicians respond again with genres including hardcore, post-punk, and riot grrrl. However, the history of punk is not directed or simple, and neither is genre; history and genre share an inability to be boxed, and yet, ironically, both are continually categorized and reframed.

In *Roots Punk: A Visual and Oral History*, David A. Ensminger continues to frustrate punk's narrative by injecting anecdotal counter evidence on how punk bands are influenced by rock, R&B, country, americana, and other "roots" styles. Roots music "connects to a series of genres widely circulated among everyday people in the form of 'people's music'" (p. 24). In this way, roots and punk are similar: according to Wendy Case, singer and songwriter of the Paybacks, "they both come from a linear style of storytelling. Simple and direct, not a lot of wanking and wasted notes" (p. 25). Rather than lay out a well-defined historical lineage, each chapter of *Roots Punk* highlights an artist with interviews from punk bands most active and influential from the late-'70s to mid-'80s. The interviewed artists are based in the Western U.S.—primarily Austin and L.A.—and include artists such as Robert Lopez (El Vez), Texacala (Tex and the Horseheads), Dave Alvin (X/The Blasters), Gary Floyd (The Dicks), Peter Case (Pig Nation/The Nerves/Plimsouls), and more. Interviews are complemented with photos, album covers, posters, etc.

The book's strengths can be put into three categories: its 1) organization and medium, 2) provocative engagement with genre boundaries, and 3) representation of punk's diverse landscape. The book is organized into short, compartmentalized chapters, where, as mentioned, each chapter is a snapshot of an artist. This means a reader can immerse themselves in any chapter and need not read diachronically; the reader's immersion is aided by the accompanying posters from artists' performances. In terms of genre, the book supplements the traditional history of punk with examples questioning genre boundaries writ large. For example, the Kinman siblings "revoked their punk and headed south to Austin... [in] doing so, they opted for restless, sincere, stripped-down twang" (p. 129). And despite being a book on punk, there are lengthy discussions about the influence of Elvis, Coltrane, Wagner, and others on punk, encouraging a musical omnivorousness from the reader. Outside of musical inspirations, the book also problematizes stereotypes about punk musicians. For example, Dave Dictor, singer and founder of MDC, plays with acoustic guitars and is an avid supporter for veganism—two signifiers of the hippie counter

culturalism antithetical to punk. Punk is often represented by white, cis straight men, but Ensminger also highlights punk's diversity through race (el Vez, Bad Brains, Pierce, Kevin Carnes, Beatnigs), sexuality (Gary Floyd), and gender (Texacala Jones).

Before ordering the book however, there are a few details readers should know. By framing history in terms of anecdotal interviews, the book can engage more deeply with music at a humanitarian scale, but doing so means the book prioritizes the local scene over a larger history of punk; the book is centered on punk in the Southwest (particularly Austin, Texas, and southern California), emphasizing depth rather than breadth, and a reader is plunged within the Southwest's punk scene in the mid- to late-20th century. If a reader is not familiar with traditional histories of punk, they might be left wondering about the significance of these bands; bands and artists are treated on equal footing regardless of larger impact. To situate the book in the landscape of American punk, I recommend readers first turn to Spitz and Mullen, *We Got the Neutron Bomb* (2001) for a broader perspective on L.A. punk. Additionally, *Please Kill Me: The Uncensored Oral History of Punk* (McNeil and McCain, 1996) is another topical source: the book contains a similar interview format, but does so with east coast bands (primarily around New York). This decentralizing complicates the genre and history and is, I believe, an intentional choice to disrupt canonization, but it may be misleading for a reader green to punk styles. The quote about the Kinman siblings marks a contrast to other linear views of genre "evolution": many bands reacted to hardcore by shifting to a more emotionally charged style, or *emotional hardcore* (the first kernels of "emo"). This and other marked details may be overlooked by a reader without such prior knowledge.

As for a recommendation, while I am sure that any reader can gain something from the book, I think it is best suited for three different categories of readers: the historian, the listener, or the academic. The historian will read to supplement their understanding of punk's not-so-linear progression; the listener may know some of the bands, will read about music they know, and find similar artists (whether that be musical, aesthetic, or political); and the academic will read *Roots Punk* to interrogate what genre *means*. At the end of *Roots Punk*, we stare not at the monolithic lineage of punk-rock, but the reality of music history, a fragmented, brittle mosaic of musical influences; by dismantling and frustrating historical narratives, the book embodies its own punk ethos. Ultimately, the book successfully portrays genre and punk history as "a motley American milieu" (p. 29) and, in so doing, encourages us to reexamine the generic edifices we assume in our musical lives.

Reviewed by Matt Chiu

Nefarious Artists: The Evolution and Art of the Punk Rock Post-Punk and New Wave Hardcore Punk and Alternative Rock Compilation Record 1976–1989.
By Welly Artcore. Ticehurst: Earth Island Books, 2023. 412pp (paperback). Illustrations (color), Chronology, Annotated Discography, ISBN 978-1-91-686412-2. \$35

Historically zines are DIY (do it yourself) productions that are made with low quality printers and makeshift layouts. The authors and publishers are traditionally fans of the subjects they write about and rarely scholars. The phenomenon of zines was born out of the DIY culture of punk in the late 1970s, although one can trace the origins back to Dada, the Lettrists International, and the Situationists. The historical value of zines is the representation of the reception of popular art and music as it happened by the fans of the